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Toh 775 · Derge Kangyur

This short work is a dhāraṇī text, likely known in Sanskrit as something like the Ratnaketu-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as connected to the Rin chen rgyal mtshan (Ratnaketu) tradition, and it belongs to the Kangyur's collection of dhāraṇī and ritual formulas. It opens by concluding a prior rite—the "Dhāraṇī of Polishing the Jewel," in which offerings are visualized as filling the whole of space—before turning to homage and a mantra addressed to the Tathāgata Ratnaketu, the "Jewel Banner" Buddha. It then introduces a further short spell, the "Dhāraṇī of Circumambulation," which promises that reciting it while making even a single circumambulation is equivalent in merit to countless circumambulations. As Toh 775 in the Kangyur, the text exemplifies the genre of brief liturgical dhāraṇīs used in devotional and ritual practice, combining invocation, mantra recitation, and the accumulation of merit through symbolic acts of offering and circumambulation.

One should imagine it filling the entire expanse of space, and then make the offering.

The Dhāraṇī of Polishing the Jewel is complete.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Ratnaketu (Jewel Banner).

Namo bhagavate ratnaketurājāya tathāgatāya arhate samyaksambuddhāya.
Tadyathā: oṃ ratne ratne mahāratne ratnavijaye svāhā.

Reciting this and performing even a single circumambulation becomes equivalent to performing immeasurable circumambulations.

The Dhāraṇī of Circumambulation—

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit mantra syllables in the source are somewhat corrupted in transliteration (e.g., "saṃ mya kṣaṃ du ra dhā ya" for what is clearly intended as "samyaksambuddhāya"); the translation above reconstructs the standard, evidently intended Sanskrit form of this well-known Ratnaketu dhāraṇī. The final phrase "The Dhāraṇī of Circumambulation" is a section heading marking the start of the next text, where the passage breaks off.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.